

1. Math via the Base14 path

`#set text(font: "Helvetica")` routes through Mosaic's Base14 encoder, which layers a per-document `/Differences` array on top of `WinAnsiEncoding` to reach the AFM glyphs beyond WinAnsi. The ten math symbols Adobe ships in every Core 14 Latin AFM are available without embedding any font — the outlines come from the reader's built-in Helvetica.

Inequalities: $a \leq b$, $x \geq y$, $p \neq q$.

Calculus: $\partial f / \partial x = 0$, $\sum a = 1$, $\sqrt{n} \geq 0$.

Geometry: $\triangle ABC$, optional steps marked $\diamond$.

The minus operator ($a - b$) uses U+2212, distinct from the ASCII hyphen-minus ($a - b$). The fraction slash ($1/2$) uses U+2044.

1.1. Coverage

This path covers exactly ten math glyphs — `lessequal`, `greaterequal`, `notequal`, `partialdiff`, `summation`, `radical`, `minus`, `Delta`, `lozenge`, `fraction` — the AGL- named glyphs every Core 14 Latin AFM ships. Symbols outside that list (infinity, forall, exists, element-of, nabla, product, oplus, otimes, sub/superscripts, calligraphic and blackletter alphabets) require font embedding and are unreachable through the `/Differences` path. The eventual fix is bundling Noto Sans Math with per-glyph font fallback so math codepoints route through it while body text stays in the primary family — tracked as a follow-up to issue #9.

1.2. Caveat

Glyph coverage past WinAnsi depends on each PDF reader's chosen Helvetica substitute, not just on Mosaic emitting a correct `/Differences` declaration. Even within the poppler family, different installs (GNOME Papers vs Evince vs zathura) can pick different substitute fonts via `fontconfig` and end up with different glyph coverage — `lozenge` ($\diamond$) in particular is prone to being absent. Adobe Reader has separately been observed to mis-render `/Differences` -mapped glyphs by splicing in spacing-substitution composition (Romanian comma-below in particular). If you target a specific reader and rely on any specific glyph from the AGL math subset, verify the rendering on that reader before shipping.